

Perineal Urethrostomy

WARWIKI

Patient Information · A new, permanent opening for urine in the perineum

A perineal urethrostomy makes a new, permanent opening for urine in the perineum. The perineum is the area between the scrotum and the anus. This surgery is used when the urethra is too narrow, scarred or damaged to repair well. Afterward, you urinate sitting down through this opening instead of through the tip of the penis.

About This Procedure

A **stricture** is a scarred, narrow part of the urethra that blocks urine. Sometimes the narrowing is long, keeps coming back, or the urethra is too damaged to rebuild. Then the surgeon brings the **healthy part of the urethra**, behind the narrowing, to the skin of the perineum. It is stitched open to make a new, wide opening. Urine leaves the body there.

It is a **reliable, lasting** choice. It can avoid longer or repeated repairs, and it suits people who would rather not have several operations.

Benefits and Risks in Numbers

about

9 in 10

need no more surgery in the first few years

1–2 in 10

find the new opening narrows over time

7 in 10

openings were still working 10 years later in one large study

Numbers are averages from published studies. Your own risk may differ; ask your team.

What to Know

The main change is that you **urinate sitting down** through the new opening. Most men adjust and are satisfied. Your **penis stays in place**, and bladder control is usually not affected. Most men keep their erections, but some notice a change. If the opening narrows, a small procedure can often open it again.

Learn the Terms

Urethra

The tube that carries urine out of the body.

Stricture

A scarred, narrow part of the urethra that blocks urine flow.

Perineum

The area between the scrotum and the anus, where the new opening is made.

Perineal urethrostomy

The operation that makes a new, permanent urine opening in the perineum.

Stoma

The new opening where urine leaves the body.

Stomal narrowing

The new opening getting tighter over time. It can often be fixed with a small procedure.

Catheter

A soft tube left in place for a short time while the opening heals.

Sitz bath

Sitting in a few inches of warm water to soothe and clean the area.

Will it hurt? You will be asleep or numb from the waist down, so you feel nothing during surgery. Afterward, expect swelling, bruising and soreness in the perineum for 1–2 weeks. Sitz baths, ice and pain medicine help. Many people go home the same day or the next day.

First days

Soreness and swelling. A catheter drains urine.

Catheter out

Often after a few days. Longer if a cheek graft was used.

Weeks 1–2

Swelling settles. You urinate sitting down.

Later

Tell your team if your stream weakens, even years later.

How to Get Ready

- Follow your surgery instructions about eating, drinking and which medicines to stop, including blood thinners.
- A **urine test** checks for infection. Any infection is treated first.
- **Stop smoking.** It slows healing. Arrange a ride home.

Tell your team ahead of time if you:

- Have had **pelvic radiation**. The new opening is more likely to narrow.
- Take a blood thinner, or have an infection

What Happens During Surgery

- 1 You get general or spinal anesthesia and antibiotics. Your legs rest in supports.
- 2 Through a cut in the perineum, the surgeon finds the healthy urethra behind the narrowing.
- 3 The urethra is stitched open to the skin to make a wide opening. A catheter is placed.

After Surgery

- Keep the area clean. Your team will give you the date the catheter comes out.
- Avoid heavy lifting, straining, cycling and sex until your team says it is safe.

Call the office that did your surgery if you have:

- A temperature of **100.4 °F (38 °C)** or higher, or chills
- Redness, swelling or pain that is getting worse, or fluid leaking from the wound
- A catheter that falls out, or a stream that weakens

Go to an emergency department if:

- You cannot urinate, or the catheter stops draining, and your bladder feels full or painful
- Heavy bleeding that does not stop with firm pressure
- You cannot reach the office and are worried

Three Things to Remember

1. You will urinate sitting down through a new opening. Your penis stays in place.
2. It is a lasting choice that can avoid repeated repairs.
3. The opening can narrow. Tell your team if your stream weakens.